

Curriculum Vitae

David Zaddach

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Profile

Senior Director / Head of Product (Technology) | Enterprise platforms in music, copyright & data

Target role: Chief Product Officer, VP Product or Head of Technology Products in music, media & enterprise platforms

Skills & knowledge

- Executive product & technology leadership
- Portfolio strategy, prioritisation & multi-year roadmaps
- P&L ownership, budgeting & vendor governance
- B2B platform scaling (music / copyright / data)
- Stakeholder & board-level communication
- Music publishing, licensing & copyright operations
- AI strategy and applied expertise (LLMs, agentic systems, human-in-the-loop)
- Agentic coding and AI-assisted software delivery
- Domain depth: music publishing, licensing & copyright operations
- Digital transformation, platform thinking & innovation

Professional experience

Senior Director Technology Products, Head of Product July 2023 to present

- Lead 15 product owners (internal and external), 10 vendor partners and 150+ developers; align business units and engineering to deliver at scale
- Led decommissioning of legacy monolithic copyright and royalties platform (iMaestro); delivered sync pitching tool, microservices, headless architecture and APIs for AI transformation
- Full-cycle budget and vendor governance: selection, performance, risk, planning, prioritisation, approvals, forecasting and in-year control

Director Business Services Jan. 2023 to July 2023

- Drove evolution of business services products and operating processes; improved service delivery and operational readiness across the unit
- Aligned operations, product and business stakeholders on priorities and roadmap; reduced handoff friction and kept cross-functional delivery on track

Senior Product Owner Business Services

May 2022 to Dec. 2022

- Owned business services backlog and priorities; translated requirements into a focused roadmap aligned with business outcomes
- Partnered with engineering and business teams to clarify scope, unblock delivery and maintain predictable release cadence

ICE (International Copyright Enterprise) / ICE Services GmbH, Germany

Senior Product Owner

May 2020 to April 2022

- Owned outcomes for all online processing systems and two Scrum teams; delivered roadmap priorities for ICE's licensing back office serving collecting societies and publishers
- Aligned business, IT, customer and shareholder stakeholders on backlog and releases; kept cross-functional delivery predictable at platform scale
- Drove online operations coordination including dispute management; improved reliability and throughput of high-volume copyright and licensing workflows
- Translated operational and regulatory requirements into backlog priorities; sustained continuous delivery across the online processing portfolio

Earlier roles: product management and business analysis

2015 to 2020

- Progressed from senior product manager and business analyst to product owner for ICE's online copyright and licensing platform.
- Owned requirements, specifications and backlog prioritisation for online processing systems and platform development.
- Partnered with engineering on continuous delivery and aligned releases with business and operational goals.

freenet digital GmbH (Jesta Digital & Fox Mobile Distribution), Berlin

Earlier career: product, content operations and team leadership

2008 to 2015

- Progressed from team lead for audio production and content ingestion to product manager for mobile products and content services.
- Built content operations, CMS workflows and partner onboarding; introduced Scrum and scaled music as a core mobile content category.
- Owned roadmaps, KPI tracking and launch delivery across content ingestion, licensing, metadata and mobile product releases.

Further experience

Music production & independent label

2000 to present

- Ongoing music production; selected projects with artists such as Knaller Soundsystem and David Main.
- Co-founded and managed independent label 24-7 Records (2003 to 2005).

Internships and early industry roles

1999 to 2008

- Universal Music, Berlin — internship in product coordination / operations (2007 to 2008).
- Project work in marketing & PR at Akademie der Künste, Studio for Electroacoustic Music, Berlin (2006).

- Sound recording / engineering for short film "Wasser & Papayas" (2006).
- Project work in marketing & PR at Rianoni Music, Berlin (2005).
- Moneypenny, Paris — music production internship (2002).
- DResearch Digital Media Systems GmbH — assistant on projects and administration (1999 to 2001).

Education

Magister Artium , Technische Universität Berlin

Graduated 2007

- Overall grade: very good.
- Master thesis (German title): Die Nutzung der Zensur aus künstlerischen und ökonomischen Interessen in der Populärmusik (grade: very good).
- Major: musicology (2002 to 2007).
- Minors: economics, communication science.

Certifications (selection)

- Bertelsmann IT Circle (3 years project for IT experts within Bertelsmann)
- ITIL (Information Technology Infrastructure Library) certification
- Various Product Management and scrum trainings

Languages

- German: native
- English: fluent
- French: basic

Berlin, 12 May 2026